

The Google Business Profile Checklist for Market Stalls & Vendors

23 things to fix on your Google listing so customers find you at this week's market — not last month's.

You don't have a shop. You've got a stall, a trestle table, and a different postcode every weekend. That makes Google Business Profile setup a bit different to the small-shop checklists you've probably read.

Set up right, GBP becomes a free way for locals to find you wherever you're trading this Saturday — and to buy direct between markets. This checklist covers the bits that actually matter for vendors. Takes about 45 minutes. Print it, tick each box as you go.

1. Foundation (as a service-area business)

SET UP HONESTLY — YOU HAVE NO FIXED SHOPFRONT

☐ Claim and verify your listing

If Google doesn't trust you own the business, you can't edit anything. Search your maker / vendor name on Google and look for "Own this business?"

☐ Real business name — not the market name

"Mallacoota Beeswax Co" not "Mallacoota Sunday Market Stall." The maker brand, the one on your labels.

☐ Set as a service-area business — HIDE the street address

In your GBP dashboard, switch to "I deliver goods and services to my customers" and HIDE the home address. List service areas (towns / regions you trade in) instead. Listing your home address is a privacy and verification mess.

☐ Phone number is the one you'll answer between markets

Your mobile. The one with your customers' messages on it. Not a number that goes to voicemail forever.

☐ Website link points to your own site (or Linktree)

Your own domain ideally. If you sell mainly via Etsy or Instagram, link a single page (your own site or a Linktree) that gathers all your channels — not Etsy directly.

2. Categories & Attributes

TELL GOOGLE EXACTLY WHAT YOU MAKE

- ☐ **Primary category specific to what you actually make**
"Jeweller," "Pottery studio," "Honey farm," "Sauce maker," "Soap maker," "Bakery" — pick the most specific. "Jeweller" beats "Retail store" every time.
 - ☐ **Add 2–4 secondary categories**
"Wholesaler," "Custom order specialist," "Gift shop" if they apply. Don't pad with things that aren't true.
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- ☐ **Tick relevant attributes — custom orders, online appointments, payment methods**
Custom orders, online appointments, in-store pickup (at market), card payments, cash payments. Customers filter by these.

3. Description & Markets Served

WHERE YOU TRADE, WHAT YOU MAKE, HOW TO REACH YOU BETWEEN MARKETS

- ☐ **Description fills the full 750 characters**
Plain English. Mention what you make, the markets you regularly attend (Mallacoota, Bairnsdale, Lakes Entrance, Bemm River), and how people can buy between markets (online orders, custom commissions, DM on Insta).
 - ☐ **Service-area list covers every town you trade in**
In GBP, add each town as a service area. This helps you rank when people search "[your craft] [town]" even if you only trade there one Sunday a month.
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- ☐ **Public-holiday + off-season hours added**
If you stop trading in winter, set "Closed" for those weeks. If you do extra markets at Christmas, set hours for those too. Lets customers know whether to expect you.

4. The Schedule — Your #1 Lever

A LIVE WEEKLY POST: "FIND US AT [MARKET] THIS SATURDAY"

- ☐ **Post a GBP update EVERY market week**
"Find us at the Mallacoota Sunday Market this weekend, 9am–1pm." Same template, swap the market + date. Counts as a fresh signal AND shows up directly in your listing when locals search.
 - ☐ **Link a schedule page on your site / Linktree / Insta bio**
A single, kept-current page listing the next 4–8 markets you'll be at. Link it from your GBP description and from every "find us at" post. The schedule is what people came for.
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☐ **Top products added to "Products" on GBP — photo, name, price**

Even without a shop, products show up in "[your craft] near me" searches. Add 6–10 hero products with clear photos, names, current prices. Update when ranges change.

5. Photos

HERO PRODUCTS + THE MAKER — THIS IS WHAT GETS PEOPLE TO YOUR STALL

☐ **Hero product shots, daylight, plain background**

Your best-sellers, clean shots, no clutter. These show up in "[product] near me" searches and in your products carousel.

☐ **The stall set up — wide shot from across the path**

So locals recognise your stall when they're walking the markets. Bunting, signage, the table laid out. Helps them spot you in the crowd.

☐ **Maker / process shots**

Hands at the wheel, the wax pouring, the bread proving. People love the maker story — show how the stuff actually gets made. Drives trust and price tolerance.

☐ **Market atmosphere, refreshed monthly**

A bustling stall, customers chatting, kids tasting the honey. Shows the vibe people are coming for. Add a fresh photo monthly; Google rewards active listings.

6. Direct Orders & Pickup at Markets

CAPTURE THE CUSTOMER WHO MISSED THE MARKET BUT WANTS THE PRODUCT

☐ **Order link goes to your own site — not Etsy**

In the GBP dashboard, set the "Order online" link to your own shop page. Etsy takes a listing fee + a 6.5% transaction cut + payment processing — your own checkout keeps that.

☐ **Offer "pre-order, pickup at next market"**

A standing offer on your site and in your GBP description: customers order online and you bring the order to the next market they pick. No shipping cost, no Etsy fees, locked-in walk-up.

☐ **Messaging turned on (and someone's watching it)**

Lets customers text you between markets to ask about stock, custom orders, or where you'll be next. Reply within a day — vendors with fast replies get the repeat sales.

Why this matters

Your customer base is bigger than the people who walk past your stall on a Saturday. Locals who saw you once, took your card, then forgot which market you're at next week — that's the audience GBP recaptures for free. Direct orders + pickup at the next market means you keep margin AND lock in the next visit.

7. Reviews, Posts & Q&A

THE ONGOING WORK THAT KEEPS YOU AHEAD OF QUIETER VENDORS

☐ Reply to every review — good and bad

Within 48 hours. By name, personalised, never copy-paste. Most vendors never reply — you'll stand out instantly just by doing it.

☐ Set up a review request system

A QR code on a card at the stall, a thank-you DM after a custom order, your Google review link in your Linktree. Aim for one new review per market.

☐ Get your short Google review link

In your GBP dashboard, click "Ask for reviews" — copy that short link, print it on the QR card, paste it into your Linktree and Insta bio.

☐ Cross-link GBP ↔ Instagram / Facebook

Add your socials to the GBP profile; link your GBP listing in your Insta bio. Cross-traffic between channels boosts both. The schedule + photos can live on Insta too.

☐ Pre-load the Q&A section

Add the questions customers actually ask — do you take cards, do you do custom orders, where's your next market, do you ship — and answer them yourself. Saves you replying 50 times.

Done it all? Here's what's next.

If you've ticked every box, your Google Business Profile is now in better shape than 95% of makers and market vendors in your region. Want a hand turning weekend-only customers into year-round ones? Get in touch — find me on Facebook or Instagram as Your Mate Agency, or my email and number are right below.

Your Mate Agency — helping regional businesses get found online.

Built by Matt Rowlands in Mallacoota, East Gippsland.

matt@yourmateagency.com.au · 0478 101 521 · yourmateagency.com.au